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happen. We began on a sour note, losing to New Zealand. It was a shocker. I remember the games against West Germany, Japan, East Germany and Mexico. The wins put us on the road to the semifinals after a hard-earned victory against

Spain. There were murmurs of a rift in the team even as we watched the semifinal against Australia.

A win for Australia was heartbreaking. Losing the gold in hockey was nothing short of a catastrophe, and I must say I was

crestfallen. The signs of losing our dominance in hockey were there for all to see. It was painful to see India take on West Germany for a bronze medal. We won that match, but not everything was good in Indian hockey. The rift in the team had cost dear. I am now looking forward to the Paris Olympics. **There are great expectations from the shooting contingent and some other athletes as well.**

Neeraj Chopra is looking good to retain his gold in the javelin throw. I will be in the stands to cheer on the hockey boys, who promise to better the bronze medal they won in Tokyo.

As told to Vijay Lokapally

We were provided with a delightful Games village. It was a very welcoming place with people gathered around and athletes singing in every corner of the stadium